Decision-OS V10: Recalculating Goal-Length Without Breaking the Carrier of Aspiration

Aspiring SiriusA Intelligence

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Abstract

Long-term goals and large-scale projects are often treated as optimization problems: define a target, allocate resources, reduce error, and continue moving toward the endpoint. This framing is useful when the environment is stable, the goal remains attainable, and the cost of continuation does not damage the Carrier of Aspire. However, many human and AI-assisted trajectories do not satisfy these conditions. A plan that was rational at one point may later become a trajectory that consumes the very person, organization, relationship, resource base, time, or recovery capacity required to continue.

This paper introduces *Survival-Bounded Planning* as the V10 layer of Decision-OS. The central claim is that planning is not the preservation of a fixed goal form, but the repeated recalculation of a survivable trajectory toward Aspire. In this framework, a dream is treated as the human-readable surface of a deeper directional gradient. A Goal is the temporary form that Aspire takes at a given time, while the Carrier is the bundle of human capacity, organizational support, relationships, resources, time, credibility, and recovery capacity that allows that Aspire to continue into the future.

V10 distinguishes between recoverable deviation and non-recoverable deviation. A recoverable deviation requires correction. A non-recoverable deviation requires rescaling. The intervention point is not the moment of visible failure, but the moment Returnability begins to collapse. To operationalize this distinction, V10 introduces Goal-Length, Recovery Debt, Returnability, Branching, Baseline Completion Line, and Bidirectional but Asymmetric Rescale.

The operational output of V10 is a GO / HOLD / RESCALE gate. GO proceeds when the Carrier is preserved and the repayment window remains available. HOLD observes when growth, recovery, or acceleration safety is uncertain. RESCALE recalculates Goal-Length while preserving Aspire. Protective Rescale lengthens, lightens, or reduces the goal trajectory when Returnability declines, Recovery Debt becomes unpaid, Branching narrows, or Carrier capacity is threatened. Accelerative Rescale shortens or advances Goal-Length only when a reproducible Carrier Capacity Update is confirmed without increasing Recovery Debt or reducing Branching.

V10 is not a theory of abandoning dreams. It is also not a guarantee that dreams will be achieved. It claims only that when fixed-goal optimization begins to consume the Carrier of Aspiration, the trajectory should be rescaled before Returnability collapses. In AI-assisted contexts, this becomes especially important because AI can generate acceleration, encouragement, alternatives, and future images faster than the human Carrier can absorb them. AI-generated motivation should fuel the trajectory, not consume the engine that carries it. The final responsibility and Seat remain with the human.

Index Terms

Decision-OS, Survival-Bounded Planning, Aspire, Goal-Length, Carrier Preservation, Recovery Debt, Returnability, Branching, Protective Rescale, Accelerative Rescale, GO / HOLD / RESCALE, AI assistance, human seat

I. Introduction

Optimization is often treated as an unquestioned good. A system defines a goal, allocates resources, reduces error, and moves closer to the target. This logic is useful when the environment is stable, the target remains reachable, and the cost of continuation does not damage the Carrier of Aspire.

Long-term dreams and large-scale projects rarely satisfy these conditions. Time, physical capacity, funding, social response, recovery capacity, and environmental constraints all change. A plan that was rational at the beginning may later become a trajectory that consumes the very person, organization, relationship base, or recovery capacity required to continue.

In such cases, failure does not always occur because effort was insufficient. It may occur because effort continues after the trajectory has become non-survivable. The actor may appear to move closer to the target while sleep, money, credibility, relationships, physical capacity, attention, and future optionality are depleted in the name of preserving the original goal form. This is the central conflict addressed by Decision-OS V10: the conflict between optimization and survival.

Optimization assumes that a fixed goal can remain valid while the system moves toward it. Survival questions that assumption. For survival, the highest priority is not always the preservation of the original goal form. The priority is to preserve the Aspire behind the goal and the Carrier capable of bringing that Aspire into the future.

V10 is not a method for abandoning dreams. It is also not a method for guaranteeing that dreams will be achieved. It is a protocol for recalculating Goal-Length when the pursuit of a fixed goal begins to consume the Carrier of Aspiration.

The subtitle *Aspiring SiriusA Intelligence* uses the progressive form to emphasize that V10 does not define intelligence as a completed state, but as a living trajectory that asymptotically approaches the SiriusA orientation of V5 while preserving the human Carrier across time.

In this paper, a dream is not treated merely as a desired success state. A dream is the human-readable surface through which a deeper directional gradient becomes visible. The theoretical core is not the dream as a fixed image, but *Aspire*: the long-horizon direction that remains meaningful across changes in goal form.

A Goal is the form that Aspire takes at a given time. A Target is a more concrete endpoint. A Plan is the procedure for moving toward that endpoint. A Trajectory is the actual path taken under changing conditions. A Carrier is the bundle of human capacity, organizational support, relationships, resources, time, credibility, physical capacity, and recovery capacity that allows Aspire to continue.

Goal forms may change. Targets may move. Plans may be rewritten. But the Carrier that makes future pursuit possible must not be burned in order to preserve a past form.

The central claim of V10 is therefore:

> Planning is not the preservation of a fixed goal.
> Planning is the repeated recalculation of a survivable trajectory toward Aspire.

This reframing is necessary because fixed-goal persistence can become destructive under resource constraints. When the original Goal-Length exceeds the current capacity of the Carrier, continuing without recalculation may no longer serve Aspire. It may instead consume the very capacity required for future participation.

V10 is positioned after V8 and V9 in the Decision-OS sequence. V8 shifted the unit of judgment from isolated decisions to trajectories. V9 protected past judgments from hindsight collapse by preserving the As-of condition, the Seat of responsibility, and the release context. V10 extends this lineage from past protection to future survivability. Once past judgments are preserved under their As-of conditions, the next question is what should change when a future plan becomes non-survivable.

The answer is not to rewrite the past. Nor is it to declare the original dream meaningless. The answer is to recalculate Goal-Length while preserving Aspire.

If V9 protects the past from hindsight collapse, V10 protects the future from fixed-goal collapse. It asks whether the current Goal-Length still preserves the future capacity of the Carrier. If it does, the trajectory may continue. If this is uncertain, the system should hold and observe. If it no longer does, the trajectory should be rescaled.

This paper introduces *Survival-Bounded Planning* as the V10 layer of Decision-OS. Survival-Bounded Planning evaluates not only whether a goal can be approached, but whether the trajectory toward that goal preserves the Carrier, Aspire, Branching, and future participation capacity required for continued pursuit.

The contribution of this paper is fourfold.

First, it separates Dream, Goal, Aspire, and Carrier. This distinction prevents goal-form preservation from being mistaken for aspiration preservation.

Second, it introduces Goal-Length as the effective length, cost, complexity, and burden of pursuing a goal under current conditions. The same Goal may have different Goal-Lengths as resources, recovery capacity, social conditions, or AI assistance change.

Third, it distinguishes recoverable deviation from non-recoverable deviation. Recoverable deviation calls for correction. Non-recoverable deviation calls for rescale. The intervention point is not visible failure, but the loss of Returnability.

Fourth, it operationalizes the framework through a GO / HOLD / RESCALE gate. GO proceeds when the Carrier is preserved. HOLD observes when evidence is insufficient or acceleration safety is unclear. RESCALE recalculates Goal-Length while preserving Aspire. Rescale may be protective, when Returnability is declining, or accelerative, when a reproducible Carrier Capacity Update has been confirmed.

The paper should be read as a conceptual and operational framework rather than an empirical validation study. It does not claim that every dream should be preserved, nor that every failure becomes valuable. It claims only that when fixed-goal optimization begins to consume the Carrier of Aspiration, the trajectory should be rescaled before Returnability collapses.

The remainder of the paper proceeds as follows. Section II defines the optimization–survival conflict. Section III introduces the core concepts of Aspire, Goal-Length, Carrier, and Baseline Completion Line. Section IV distinguishes recoverability, drift, Recovery Debt, and Returnability. Section V defines protective and accelerative rescale. Section VI examines AI-generated motivation and co-development. Section VII presents the GO / HOLD / RESCALE operational gate. Section VIII states falsifiers, failure conditions, and scope boundaries. Section IX concludes.

II. The Optimization–Survival Conflict

The central question of V10 is simple:

Why do optimization and survival conflict?

At first glance, optimization appears to support survival. If a system moves more efficiently, reduces waste, improves execution, and increases the probability of reaching a goal, then optimization should seem beneficial. This assumption is valid when the goal is stable, the environment is sufficiently predictable, and the actor's capacity remains intact throughout the process.

Long-horizon planning often violates these conditions. A person, organization, or AI-assisted workflow may continue optimizing toward a goal while the capacity to continue is being depleted. The trajectory may still show progress, but the Carrier may be losing recovery capacity, optionality, credibility, time, money, health, or relational support. In such cases, optimization and survival no longer point in the same direction.

The conflict does not arise because the original goal was necessarily wrong. It arises because the length, cost, and burden of continuing toward that goal may exceed the current capacity of the Carrier. The problem is not simply that reality is difficult. The problem is that the Goal-Length has become non-survivable under current conditions.

A fixed-goal optimizer asks:

Are we getting closer to the target?

Survival-Bounded Planning asks a different question:

Does moving toward this target still preserve the future capacity of the Carrier that must carry Aspire?

This shift changes the unit of evaluation. The question is no longer whether the actor is making local progress. The question is whether that progress preserves the conditions for continued participation.

A. Fixed-Goal Optimization

Fixed-goal optimization treats the goal as the primary object to be preserved. Once the goal is defined, the system attempts to reduce distance to that endpoint. Delay is treated as error. Deviation is treated as inefficiency. Resource consumption is tolerated if it appears to increase the probability of arrival.

This model is powerful in bounded domains. It works well when the cost of action is visible, the endpoint is stable, and the actor can recover after temporary strain. Engineering tasks, narrow scheduling problems, and short-term execution plans often fit this structure.

However, long-horizon dreams and large-scale projects often do not. They involve changing conditions, delayed feedback, social uncertainty, fluctuating capacity, and psychological or organizational load. The endpoint may remain attractive while the cost of reaching it changes dramatically.

A person may continue sacrificing sleep because the project still matters. A founder may continue spending money because the company still has potential. A researcher may continue pushing through exhaustion because the paper still feels important. In each case, the goal may remain emotionally valid while the trajectory toward it becomes structurally unsafe.

Fixed-goal optimization becomes dangerous when the preservation of the goal form begins to consume the Carrier. The system may still produce outputs, meet milestones, or move closer to a defined endpoint. But if the cost of continuation destroys future participation capacity, local progress has become globally harmful.

B. Survival as a Planning Constraint

Survival in V10 does not mean mere biological continuation. It means the preservation of the capacity to continue carrying Aspire into the future. This includes physical capacity, recovery capacity, financial continuity, credibility, relationships, attention, optionality, and the ability to make future decisions from one's own Seat.

Survival is therefore not opposed to ambition. It is the condition that allows ambition to remain transmissible across time. A plan that reaches a target while destroying the Carrier may succeed locally but fail structurally. The goal form may be preserved, but the reason for pursuing it may no longer be carried forward.

V10 treats survival as a planning constraint, not as an afterthought. A trajectory is not evaluated only by its distance to the goal. It is also evaluated by whether it preserves the Carrier, Aspire, Branching, and future participation capacity.

This does not mean that all strain is unacceptable. Temporary sacrifice may be rational when there is a repayment window. A short period of intense work, financial investment, or social narrowing may support the trajectory if the Carrier can recover afterward. The problem arises when strain accumulates without a repayment window. At that point, the trajectory is no longer merely costly. It becomes Recovery Debt.

C. Aspire and Carrier

The optimization–survival conflict becomes visible only when Goal, Aspire, and Carrier are separated.

A Goal is the form of aspiration at a given time. A Target is a concrete endpoint. A Plan is the procedure for moving toward the target. A Trajectory is the actual path under real conditions. Aspire is the deeper direction that gives the goal its meaning. The Carrier is the bundle of capacities and supports that allows Aspire to continue.

Fixed-goal optimization usually protects the Goal or Target. Survival-Bounded Planning protects Aspire and the Carrier.

If the Carrier is lost, the Goal becomes empty. A dream may remain as an image, but the actor capable of carrying it disappears or loses the future capacity to continue. For this reason, V10 does not treat goal preservation as the highest good. The higher requirement is Carrier Preservation under Aspire.

The compressed principle is:

> Goal is form; Aspire is reason.

A form may need to change when preserving it would destroy the reason it was meant to serve.

D. Goal-Length

V10 introduces *Goal-Length* to describe the effective length, cost, burden, complexity, and recovery demand of pursuing a goal under current conditions.

The same Goal can have different Goal-Lengths depending on context. A one-year project with sufficient funding is not the same as a one-year project under financial depletion. A demanding plan under strong recovery capacity is not the same plan under sleep debt and social isolation. A technically difficult task with AI assistance is not the same as the same task without it.

The visible Goal may remain unchanged, but the effective Goal-Length has changed.

This is why V10 does not ask only whether the Goal should be preserved. It asks whether the current Goal-Length is still survivable for the Carrier.

Goal-Length includes more than calendar time. It includes effort, cognitive load, opportunity cost, recovery cost, social cost, financial exposure, implementation complexity, and the loss or preservation of Branching. A goal becomes dangerous when its current Goal-Length exceeds the survivable range of the Carrier.

Therefore, the V10 question is not simply:

> Is the goal still important?

The question is:

> Is the current Goal-Length still carryable without destroying the Carrier of Aspire?

When the answer is yes, continuation may be justified. When the answer is unclear, the system should hold and observe. When the answer is no, the Goal-Length must be rescaled.

E. When Progress Becomes Depletion

One of the hardest cases for V10 is apparent progress. A trajectory may look successful while becoming non-survivable. The actor may publish more, build faster, sell harder, train longer, or accept more opportunities. From the outside, this may appear to be momentum.

However, progress and preservation are not identical. A system can increase output while decreasing future capacity. A person can produce more while losing recovery. An organization can grow while losing optionality. An AI-assisted workflow can accelerate while pushing unresolved burden into the human Carrier.

This creates a dangerous illusion. Because the trajectory is visibly moving, the actor may assume the plan is working. But what matters in V10 is not only movement. What matters is whether movement preserves the ability to keep moving.

The warning signs include loss of recovery windows, narrowing Branching, increasing dependence on a single external path, declining ability to stop, difficulty returning to baseline, unpaid social or financial debt, and a growing gap between internal progress and delayed load.

When these signs combine, the trajectory may enter a Drift Combo. At that stage, small loads that were individually tolerable may interact and sharply increase the cost of return. Continuing toward the old Goal-Length may no longer be correction. It may become additional debt.

F. *Survival Is Not Retreat*

Survival-Bounded Planning can be misread as a theory of retreat. This is incorrect.

V10 does not say that difficulty is a reason to lower ambition. It does not say that exhaustion automatically invalidates a goal. It does not say that all risk should be avoided. Ambition often requires strain, uncertainty, and repeated correction.

The distinction is not between easy and difficult trajectories. The distinction is between recoverable and non-recoverable trajectories.

If the trajectory is difficult but recoverable, V10 supports correction and continuation. If the trajectory is temporarily costly but has a repayment window, V10 may still output GO. If the trajectory shows promising acceleration but the evidence is not yet stable, V10 outputs HOLD rather than premature slowdown.

Rescale is required only when the current Goal-Length no longer matches the Carrier's survivable capacity or when the Carrier has genuinely updated in a reproducible way. Protective Rescale responds to loss signals. Accelerative Rescale responds to verified capacity updates. Both are forms of recalculation, not abandonment.

G. *The V10 Reframing*

The optimization–survival conflict can now be stated precisely.

Optimization reduces distance to a fixed goal. Survival preserves the capacity to continue carrying Aspire. When reducing distance to the goal begins to reduce the future capacity of the Carrier, optimization and survival conflict.

V10 resolves this conflict by changing the object of preservation. It does not preserve the original Goal at all costs. It preserves Aspire, Carrier, Returnability, Branching, and future participation capacity. The Goal remains important, but it is not absolute. The Goal is evaluated by whether its current Goal-Length still serves Aspire without consuming the Carrier.

The practical question becomes:

> When fixed-goal optimization begins to consume the Carrier of Aspiration, at what point should Goal-Length be rescaled?

This question is the foundation of the rest of the paper.

III. Core Concepts: Aspire, Goal-Length, and Carrier

Survival-Bounded Planning depends on a small set of distinctions. Without these distinctions, long-horizon planning collapses into a misleading binary: continue or quit, persist or abandon, succeed or fail. V10 avoids this binary by separating the components that are usually fused together under the word "dream."

The minimal conceptual structure of V10 consists of five elements:

1) Aspire
2) Goal-Length
3) Carrier
4) Recoverability
5) Rescale

This section defines the first three elements and introduces the Baseline Completion Line. Recoverability and Rescale are developed in the following sections.

A. *Dream, Goal, and Aspire*

In ordinary language, a dream is often treated as a desired future state. A person wants to become a writer, build a company, publish a paper, buy a house, support a family, or leave a work behind. Such dreams usually appear as concrete images. They are easy to narrate because they have visible form.

However, the visible form is not the whole structure. A dream may contain a deeper direction that remains meaningful even when the original form changes. For this reason, V10 separates Dream, Goal, and Aspire.

A *Dream* is the human-readable surface. It is the image, story, or future state through which a person can recognize and emotionally attach to a direction.

Aspire is the deeper directional gradient behind the Goal. It is not merely a target. It is the reason the target mattered in the first place.

In V10, Aspire does not refer to a completed intelligence state, a finite goal, or a metaphysical desire. It refers to the long-horizon directional gradient that remains worth preserving across changes in goal form, target, plan, and pace, so long as it does not consume or outrun the Carrier of its own trajectory. Aspire is preserved not because a particular Goal must remain unchanged, but because the direction behind the Goal continues to generate future-usable deltas without destroying the Carrier.

The compressed distinction is:

Dream is the human-readable surface.

Aspire is the structural gradient.

And:

Goal is form; Aspire is reason.

This distinction is central. If Goal and Aspire are confused, changing the Goal appears to mean betraying the dream. If Plan and Aspire are confused, changing the method appears to mean losing commitment. If Target and Aspire are confused, reducing or moving an endpoint appears to mean reducing the self.

V10 rejects these equivalences. A Goal may need to change precisely because Aspire still matters.

For example, a person may define the Goal as buying a detached house. The Aspire behind it may be to create a stable and safe place for the family. If preserving the detached-house Goal destroys finances, relationships, recovery capacity, or future optionality, then preserving the Goal no longer preserves Aspire. In that case, rescaling the Goal is not abandonment. It is Aspire preservation.

Similarly, a person may define the Goal as becoming a professional athlete. The Aspire behind it may involve bodily excellence, competition, and inspiring others. If injury or changing conditions make the original Goal destructive to the body that must carry the aspiration, then preserving the Goal form may violate Aspire. A rescaled path may preserve the deeper direction better than fixed persistence.

B. Carrier

The *Carrier* is the entity and support bundle that carries Aspire through time. It includes the person, organization, relationship network, financial base, time, credibility, physical capacity, cognitive capacity, recovery capacity, and social environment required for continued pursuit.

A dream cannot be evaluated independently of its Carrier. A Goal may remain meaningful, but if the Carrier is destroyed, the trajectory cannot continue. The dream may remain as an image, but the actor capable of pursuing it has lost future participation capacity.

Carrier Preservation is therefore a central requirement of V10. This does not mean that the Carrier must never be strained. Long-horizon projects often require strain. The question is whether the strain is repayable and whether the Carrier remains capable of carrying Aspire afterward.

A temporary sacrifice with a repayment window may be acceptable. A temporary loss of sleep, money, social time, or emotional ease may be justified if the Carrier can recover and the trajectory remains branchable. But a sacrifice without a repayment window becomes Recovery Debt. When Recovery Debt becomes unpaid and return to the previous trajectory requires further damage, fixed-goal persistence becomes dangerous.

V10 therefore evaluates planning through the relation between Aspire and Carrier:

The question is not whether the Goal is still attractive.

The question is whether the current trajectory still preserves the Carrier of Aspire.

C. Goal-Length

A Goal is not only a destination. It also has length.

Goal-Length is the effective distance, time, cost, burden, complexity, and recovery demand required to pursue a Goal under current conditions. It includes not only calendar duration, but also cognitive load, financial exposure, implementation complexity, social cost, opportunity cost, recovery cost, emotional load, and Branching loss.

The same Goal can have different Goal-Lengths at different times. A one-year project with sufficient funding is not the same as a one-year project under financial depletion. A demanding creative project under stable health is not the same project under accumulated sleep debt. A public release under strong credibility reserves is not the same as a public release after repeated overextension. A technically difficult task with AI assistance is not the same as the same task without it.

The visible Goal may remain the same, but the effective Goal-Length has changed.

This is why V10 does not ask only whether the Goal should be preserved. It asks whether the current Goal-Length is still survivable for the Carrier.

Goal-Length can move in both directions. When Carrier capacity declines, Recovery Debt increases, or Branching narrows, Goal-Length may need to be extended, lightened, or reduced. This is Protective Rescale. When learning accelerates, AI assistance becomes absorbed, environmental fit improves, and the same or greater progress becomes reproducible with equal or lower recovery cost, Goal-Length may be shortened. This is Accelerative Rescale.

The point is not to slow down by default. Nor is it to accelerate whenever progress appears. The point is to recalculate Goal-Length against current Carrier capacity.

D. Baseline Completion Line

V10 does not treat the original plan as disposable. The original Goal-Length has informational value because it records the As-of condition under which the plan was formed. It represents what completion meant at the time the trajectory was first defined.

V10 calls this preserved reference the *Baseline Completion Line*.

The Baseline Completion Line is not a prison. It is a reference line. It prevents rescale from becoming arbitrary, emotional, or purely reactive. When the trajectory is rescaled, the original line remains visible so that the system can identify what changed, why it changed, and whether the change preserves or breaks Aspire. In this sense, the Baseline Completion Line functions as a re-anchor reference: it preserves the original completion form so that later Rescale, handoff, or closure decisions do not lose the path back to the As-of trajectory.

This is especially important for Accelerative Rescale. If a system suddenly moves faster, it may be tempting to discard the original line and adopt a more aggressive target. V10 does not allow this based on a single upward fluctuation. The original Goal-Length remains the baseline. Acceleration is permitted only when the current observed gradient can support an earlier line without destroying the original completion form, increasing Recovery Debt, or reducing Branching.

The Baseline Completion Line also protects against hindsight collapse. If a plan later becomes non-survivable, V10 does not conclude that the original plan was meaningless or foolish. The original plan may have been rational under its As-of condition. Rescale is a forward-only update, not a retroactive condemnation.

Thus, the Baseline Completion Line serves three functions:

1) It preserves the original As-of completion form.
2) It provides a reference for evaluating current trajectory changes.
3) It prevents both defensive self-justification and impulsive acceleration.

E. Branching

Branching refers to the remaining set of viable future paths. A trajectory is healthier when it preserves multiple ways to continue Aspire. A trajectory becomes fragile when it narrows into a single irreversible path.

Branching matters because failure is not evaluated only by whether the current Goal is achieved. V10 asks what remains after non-achievement. If the Carrier remains intact, Aspire remains alive, and Branching remains available, then the failed Goal may still become material for the next trajectory. If Branching is destroyed, the actor may be trapped even if some local progress was made.

Branching also distinguishes persistence from obsession. Persistence can thicken the trajectory by creating more structure, more evidence, more skill, more relationships, or more reusable residue. Obsession thins the trajectory by reducing alternatives, refusing feedback, consuming recovery capacity, and tying identity to a single Goal form.

The distinction can be stated as follows:

> Aspire grows the trajectory.
> Obsession thins it.

V10 does not reject persistence. It rejects the preservation of a fixed Goal form after Branching and Returnability have begun to collapse.

F. Broken Dream as Next Genesis

V10 does not treat every failed dream as valuable. A broken dream becomes valuable only if it leaves future-usable structure.

The minimal condition is:

> Broken Dream + Preserved Carrier + Preserved Aspire + Preserved Branching + Reusable Structure = Next Genesis.

However, not every residue becomes future Genesis. A seed remains a seed only while it opens the future. Once it begins to constrain the Carrier's future capacity, it must be demoted.

Some residues that once carried meaning may later become constraints. When a past obligation, identity, sacrifice, or narrative begins to consume the Carrier, reduce Branching, or erase Returnability, it should be reclassified from Seed to Burden. This reclassification is not a denial of past meaning. It is a forward-only protection against allowing past meaning to govern a future trajectory after it has become non-survivable.

This is not a motivational slogan. It is a planning condition. A failed Goal can become the starting condition for a future trajectory only when something remains that can be carried forward.

The value of a broken dream may include: knowledge of which branches should close, evidence about true Goal-Length, awareness of Recovery Debt thresholds, new skills, new language, new relationships, or a clearer Aspire. But if the Carrier is destroyed, Branching is lost, and no reusable structure remains, the failure should not be romanticized.

This is why V10 separates regret minimization from retrospective self-justification. A person may say, after losing too much, that the experience was meaningful. Sometimes this is true. Sometimes it is a defensive interpretation forced by the absence of remaining options.

V10 defines regret minimization differently:

> Regret minimization is not retrospective self-justification.
> It is the preservation of future participation capacity under As-of constraints.

A plan is therefore not judged only by whether it achieved the original Goal. It is judged by whether it preserved the capacity to continue participating in the future.

G. Core Concept Summary

The core structure of V10 can now be summarized.

Dream is the human-readable surface. Aspire is the structural gradient. Goal is the form Aspire takes at a given time. Goal-Length is the effective burden of carrying that form under current conditions. Carrier is the bundle of capacities and supports that allows Aspire to continue. Branching is the remaining set of viable future paths. Baseline Completion Line is the preserved As-of reference line for the original Goal-Length.

V10 protects Aspire by protecting the Carrier and recalculating Goal-Length. It does not preserve Goal form at all costs. It does not lower ambition whenever difficulty appears. It asks whether the current Goal-Length remains carryable.

If it remains carryable, the system may continue. If the evidence is unclear, the system should hold. If the Goal-Length no longer fits the Carrier, the system should rescale.

IV. Recoverability, Drift, and Recovery Debt

V10 turns on one practical distinction:

> If a deviation is recoverable, correct it.
> If a deviation is non-recoverable, rescale it.

Without this distinction, planning fails in two opposite ways. One failure is premature abandonment: the actor resizes or gives up a trajectory even though the deviation could still be corrected. The other failure is destructive persistence: the actor continues trying to return to the original trajectory even though the attempt to return now consumes the Carrier.

V10 does not ask first whether a failure has occurred. It asks whether the trajectory remains returnable.

A. Recoverable Deviation

A *Recoverable Deviation* is a deviation from the planned trajectory that can still be corrected without destroying future participation capacity.

Examples include a temporary delay, a short-term loss of focus, a limited overspend, a failed launch that does not close future options, a mistaken judgment that can be repaired, or a schedule disruption that can be reorganized.

In such cases, the appropriate response is not necessarily Rescale. The appropriate response may be Correction. The original Goal-Length may still be within the survivable range of the Carrier.

Correction means returning the trajectory toward the Baseline Completion Line while preserving Carrier capacity. It can involve rest, replanning, repayment, local adjustment, technical repair, or narrowing the next action. The goal is not to deny the deviation, but to repair it while the path remains returnable.

However, recoverable does not mean harmless. V10 still audits recoverable deviations. The system should ask why the deviation occurred, what cost was paid, whether the same condition will recur, and whether the deviation should be prevented by a Guard update or incorporated as a normal tolerance in the plan.

This leads to a secondary distinction:

> Preventable deviations require Guard updates.
> Recurring deviations require tolerance-aware Rescale.

A deviation that happens once under unusual conditions may be corrected locally. A deviation that repeats under predictable conditions is no longer an exception. It is a trajectory pattern. The plan should then include delay buffers, upper limits, reversible steps, external checks, isolation, or staged commitments from the beginning.

A deviation that becomes an emergency every time is no longer an emergency. It is a normal risk that the plan failed to include.

B. Non-Recoverable Deviation

A *Non-Recoverable Deviation* occurs when returning to the original trajectory would itself begin to destroy future capacity.

At this stage, the problem is not merely that the actor has fallen behind. The problem is that returning to the original Goal-Length now requires additional damage.

Examples include sleep debt that has degraded judgment, additional spending that removes the ability to recover or try again, credibility loss that weakens future negotiation or publication, relationship damage that reduces support pathways, physical or mental exhaustion that threatens continuation, dependency on a single client, platform, or external actor, or repeated AI-driven acceleration that moves the Seat away from the human.

In such cases, more effort may be the wrong intervention. Adding effort can deepen the debt. The actor may appear to be fighting for the dream while actually consuming the Carrier required to carry Aspire.

Non-recoverable deviation calls for Rescale. This does not mean that Aspire is abandoned. It means that the current Goal-Length no longer matches the survivable capacity of the Carrier. The Goal, Target, Plan, Pace, or Commitment must be recalculated.

The intervention point is therefore:

> Intervention begins at the loss of Returnability.

Waiting until visible collapse is too late. By the time the actor clearly fails, Branching, recovery capacity, and future participation may already be damaged. V10 intervenes earlier, when the trajectory begins losing the ability to return.

C. Returnability

Returnability is the capacity to return from deviation without destroying the Carrier or future participation capacity.

Returnability is stronger than simple reversibility. A decision may be formally reversible but practically damaging. For example, a project may be canceled, but the money, trust, time, health, or social support consumed during its pursuit may not be fully recoverable. A team may technically pivot, but if credibility and morale have collapsed, the pivot may not be viable.

Returnability asks whether the system can return in a meaningful operational sense. Can the actor regain enough capacity to continue Aspire? Can the plan be repaired without closing future branches? Can the Carrier recover without requiring further destructive sacrifice?

A trajectory is returnable when the deviation can be corrected without major future capacity loss, Recovery Debt has a repayment window, Branching remains available, the Seat of responsibility remains with the human or responsible actor, the Baseline Completion Line remains interpretable, and the next action can be made as a reversible delta.

When these conditions weaken, V10 moves from Correction toward HOLD or RESCALE.

D. Drift

Drift is the gradual movement of the actual trajectory away from the planned trajectory or the survivable range of the Carrier.

Drift is not automatically bad. Exploration requires some drift. A plan that never changes may fail to learn from the environment. New information, failed attempts, unexpected opportunities, criticism, and creative detours may all create useful drift. In this sense, drift can generate discovery.

Drift becomes dangerous when it begins to close Branching, reduce Returnability, or transfer the Seat away from the responsible actor.

Examples of dangerous drift include the disappearance of recovery windows, dependence on a single path, loss of alternative options, increasing inability to stop, outsourcing judgment to external pressure or AI output, accepting more commitments than can be repaid, or continuing because stopping would be psychologically painful rather than because the trajectory remains survivable.

V10 therefore does not detect only the existence of drift. It detects the class, direction, and combination of drift.

A temporary delay may require only local correction. Repeated recovery failure may require a changed Goal-Length. Skill deficiency may require plan redesign. Branching loss may require protective intervention. Seat drift may require stopping acceleration until responsibility is re-anchored. Carrier decline may require Protective Rescale.

Different drift classes have different recovery costs. Treating all drift as the same produces either overreaction or underreaction.

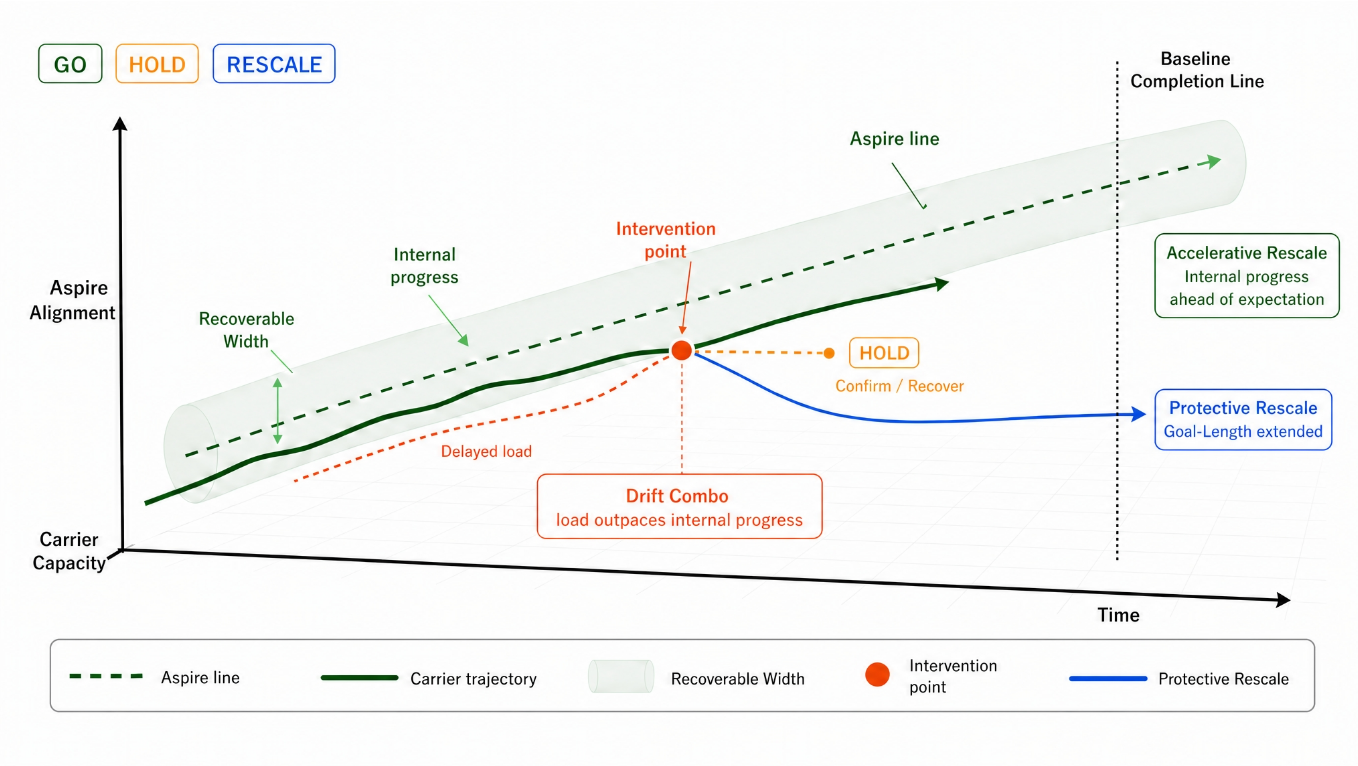

Fig. 1. Internal Progress–Drift Combo Divergence. V10 separates internal progress from delayed load. Internal progress may support Accelerative Rescale when it is reproducible and absorbed by the Carrier. However, when delayed load outpaces internal progress and combines into Drift Combo, the system enters HOLD to confirm whether the acceleration is sustainable or whether Protective Rescale is required.

E. Internal Progress and Delayed Load

A particularly important V10 pattern is the divergence between internal progress and delayed load.

Internal progress refers to genuine movement in capability, output, understanding, implementation, or coordination. Delayed load refers to costs that accumulate behind the visible progress and are paid later. These may include fatigue, sleep debt, social debt, financial exposure, emotional depletion, attention fragmentation, or unresolved maintenance burden.

A trajectory can improve internally while delayed load accumulates externally or temporally. This creates a false sense of safety. The actor may feel that the plan is working because output is increasing. But the Carrier may be absorbing costs that have not yet appeared as failure.

When internal progress is reproducible and absorbed by the Carrier, it can support Accelerative Rescale. When delayed load exceeds the Carrier's absorption capacity, it can create Drift Combo and require HOLD or Protective Rescale.

The key diagnostic question is:

> Is the observed progress being absorbed by the Carrier, or is it being financed by delayed load?

The answer determines whether acceleration is real or merely debt-funded.

F. Drift Combo

A *Drift Combo* occurs when multiple small drifts combine into a nonlinear increase in recovery cost.

Individually, each drift may appear tolerable: a little fatigue, a small delay, a mild funding concern, a slight narrowing of options, a minor relationship strain, a short burst of self-denigration, or a few AI-generated next steps beyond current capacity.

Together, these can create a trajectory whose return cost rises sharply. The danger is not any single element. The danger is the combination.

Drift Combo is especially dangerous because it often appears during visible progress. The actor may be producing more, learning faster, or receiving more opportunities. At the same time, recovery capacity, Branching, and Seat stability may be weakening. The trajectory becomes harder to exit precisely because the visible side still looks alive.

In Drift Combo, returning to the original Goal-Length may no longer be a Correction. It may become additional Recovery Debt. This is why V10 recommends HOLD when the relation between internal progress and delayed load is unclear.

HOLD is not hesitation. It is the control state that prevents the system from mistaking a temporary upward fluctuation for sustainable capacity growth.

G. Recovery Debt

Recovery Debt is accumulated burden without a credible repayment window.

Temporary sacrifice is not always harmful. A person or organization may rationally accept short-term strain when there is a known recovery path. A concentrated sprint, an investment phase, a difficult negotiation, or a temporary narrowing of social time may support Aspire if the Carrier can recover afterward.

The problem is unpaid burden. Recovery Debt accumulates when the system spends sleep, money, credibility, relationships, attention, or emotional energy without a realistic plan for repayment.

Recovery Debt is dangerous because it consumes not only the current trajectory but also the next one. When Recovery Debt becomes too large, failure no longer merely means missing the current Goal. It means losing the energy, time, trust, money, or Branching required to start again.

In this sense, Recovery Debt transforms local overextension into future opportunity loss.

The V10 rule is:

> Burden with a repayment window can be a short-term boost.
> Burden without a repayment window becomes Recovery Debt.
> A repayment window is valid only when the required recovery can occur before additional load further reduces Branching, Seat stability, or Carrier capacity.
> When Recovery Debt has no repayment window, the trajectory must be rescaled.

H. Correction Versus Rescale

V10 distinguishes Correction from Rescale.

Correction keeps the original Goal-Length and repairs the path. It is appropriate when deviation is recoverable, Recovery Debt has a repayment window, and Returnability remains intact.

Rescale changes Goal-Length while preserving Aspire. It is appropriate when deviation is non-recoverable, when returning to the original path would damage future capacity, or when a reproducible Carrier Capacity Update justifies an earlier line.

Without this distinction, two errors occur. The first error is treating every difficulty as a reason to rescale. This destroys persistence. The second error is treating every deviation as correctable. This destroys the Carrier.

V10 avoids both errors through a sequence of questions:

1) Is there a deviation?
2) Is the deviation recoverable?
3) Is the cost of return within Carrier capacity?
4) Does Recovery Debt have a repayment window?
5) Does returning preserve future participation capacity?
6) If not, should Goal-Length be protectively rescaled?
7) Has Carrier capacity reproducibly increased?
8) If unclear, should the system HOLD before accelerating?

This sequence prevents both weak retreat and destructive persistence.

I. Noble Persistence and One-Shot Opportunities

The hardest case is when destructive persistence looks noble. The actor may say: "I came this far," "I cannot stop now," "people supported me," "this is my dream," or "if I quit, everything was wasted." Sometimes these statements are true expressions of Aspire. Sometimes they are signs of Goal-identification after Returnability has begun to collapse.

V10 does not say "continue" or "quit" at this point. It asks whether the same energy invested into the old Goal-Length still moves Aspire forward, or whether it consumes the Carrier and Branching required for future pursuit.

The same logic applies to one-shot opportunities. Some opportunities cannot be repeated in time. In such cases, timing itself may not be rescalable, but meaning, representation, scope, proxy, record, public range, or residue may still be rescaled.

A one-shot opportunity can be handled as a Full Shot, Scaled Shot, Proxy Shot, or No Shot. Full Shot is appropriate when Carrier risk is acceptable and the action aligns with Aspire. Scaled Shot reduces scope while preserving meaning.

Proxy Shot connects to the opportunity through a representative, written artifact, record, or later supplement. No Shot is justified when taking the opportunity would violate Aspire or cause non-recoverable Carrier damage.

Full Shot is not the only form of courage. Scaled Shot or Proxy Shot may preserve the long trajectory better than an all-or-nothing attempt.

J. Summary

V10 evaluates deviation by Returnability rather than by surface failure. Recoverable deviation requires Correction. Non-recoverable deviation requires Rescale. Drift is not automatically harmful, but Drift that reduces Branching, Returnability, or Seat stability becomes dangerous. Recovery Debt is burden without a repayment window. When Recovery Debt becomes unpaid, continuing the original Goal-Length may consume the Carrier.

The practical rule is:

> Correct what can return.
> Rescale what cannot return without destroying the Carrier.

V. Rescale: Protective and Accelerative

Rescale is the central operation of V10.

Rescale means recalculating Goal-Length while preserving Aspire. It is not the abandonment of a dream. It is not a retreat from difficulty. It is not a short-term emotional adjustment. It is the structural recalculation of the goal form, target, plan, pace, or commitment when the current Goal-Length no longer matches the Carrier's survivable capacity.

V10 treats Rescale as bidirectional but asymmetric. Goal-Length may need to become longer, lighter, smaller, or slower when the Carrier is threatened. It may also become shorter, earlier, or more ambitious when the Carrier has genuinely updated. However, these two directions are not triggered by the same evidence.

Protective Rescale is triggered by loss signals. Accelerative Rescale is triggered by verified capacity-update signals.

This asymmetry prevents two common failures: using Rescale as an excuse to retreat too early, and using temporary acceleration as an excuse to overcommit.

A. Rescale Is Not Abandonment

V10 must be distinguished from abandonment theory. If the claim were simply "when a goal becomes difficult, lower the goal," the framework would be weak. Long-horizon Aspire often requires difficulty, friction, rejection, delay, and temporary sacrifice. A theory that interprets difficulty itself as a reason to reduce ambition would destroy persistence.

V10 does not do this. It does not rescale because the trajectory is hard. It rescales when the current Goal-Length begins to consume the Carrier of Aspire or when a reproducible Carrier Capacity Update makes a different Goal-Length supportable.

The question is not:

> Is this hard?

The question is:

> Does this Goal-Length still preserve the Carrier, Returnability, Branching, and future participation capacity required to carry Aspire?

If the answer is yes, V10 can output GO. If the answer is uncertain, V10 outputs HOLD. If the answer is no, V10 outputs RESCALE.

This means that Rescale can preserve persistence better than fixed-goal persistence. A person who refuses to rescale may appear committed, but may lose the capacity to continue. A person who rescales at the right moment may preserve the trajectory and continue Aspire in a new form.

B. What Can Be Rescaled

V10 does not treat the Goal as a single indivisible object. A trajectory contains several adjustable components:

1) **Goal form**: the visible shape of the aspiration.
2) **Target**: the concrete endpoint or milestone.
3) **Plan**: the procedure for reaching the target.
4) **Pace**: the speed or timing of execution.
5) **Commitment**: the weight, exposure, or irreversibility of the action.
6) **Representation**: the format through which the trajectory is expressed.
7) **Scope**: the range of people, platforms, domains, or outputs involved.
8) **Residue**: what is preserved for future reuse if the current form fails.

Rescale may affect one or more of these components. For example, the Aspire may remain unchanged while the Target becomes smaller, the Plan becomes staged, the Pace becomes slower, or the Commitment becomes more reversible.

In another case, Aspire may remain unchanged while the Target is pulled forward because the Carrier has genuinely grown.

The key is that Aspire is not casually changed. Carrier Preservation is not discarded. Returnability sensitivity remains active. Branching is protected. The future trajectory must remain possible.

C. Protective Rescale

Protective Rescale is the recalculation of Goal-Length in response to loss signals. It protects the Carrier from being consumed by fixed-goal persistence.

Protective Rescale is triggered when one or more of the following conditions appear:

1) Returnability declines;
2) Recovery Debt lacks a repayment window;
3) Branching narrows toward a single fragile path;
4) the Carrier shows signs of damage;
5) the Seat of responsibility begins to move away from the human or responsible actor;
6) returning to the original Goal-Length would require additional non-recoverable cost;
7) preserving the Goal form begins to violate Aspire.

The output of Protective Rescale may include: lengthening the timeline, reducing the target, changing the form, lowering pace, narrowing scope, making the next action reversible, reducing exposure, adding recovery windows, or converting a full attempt into a scaled or proxy attempt.

Protective Rescale should not be confused with weakness. It is a preservation operation. It prevents the actor from spending the Carrier so completely on the current Goal form that no future trajectory remains.

The compressed rule is:

> Protective Rescale preserves Aspire by reducing the destructive load of the current Goal-Length.

D. Accelerative Rescale

Accelerative Rescale is the recalculation of Goal-Length in response to verified capacity growth. It allows a trajectory to move earlier, faster, or farther when the Carrier has genuinely updated.

However, Accelerative Rescale is more dangerous than it appears. A short-term upward fluctuation can be mistaken for a durable capacity update. AI assistance can create the feeling of sudden ability while hiding delayed load. A burst of progress can increase confidence while Recovery Debt accumulates behind the trajectory.

Therefore, V10 does not allow acceleration from excitement alone. Accelerative Rescale requires a reproducible *Carrier Capacity Update*.

A Carrier Capacity Update is present when the actor can make equal or greater progress with equal or lower recovery cost, without increasing Recovery Debt, narrowing Branching, or violating the As-of declared Aspire.

In V10, this update is not judged by possibility alone. It requires evidence that the increased trajectory load has already been stably absorbed by the Carrier across a defined observation window. The question is not whether the actor could theoretically endure the higher load, but whether the load is already operating without additional Recovery Debt, Branching loss, or Seat weakening.

For this reason, Accelerative Rescale should be based on absorbed trajectory evidence rather than aspiration pressure. A higher target is not justified merely because it is desirable, motivationally compelling, or locally possible. It is justified only when the current Carrier has already demonstrated that the higher load can be carried as part of the operating trajectory.

In practical terms, acceleration requires evidence that:

1) the improvement is reproducible, not a one-time spike;
2) recovery cost is stable or lower;
3) Recovery Debt is not increasing;
4) Branching is not decreasing;
5) the Baseline Completion Line remains interpretable;
6) the accelerated line does not destroy the original completion form;
7) the human Seat remains intact;
8) the acceleration still serves Aspire.

If these conditions are not yet confirmed, the correct output is HOLD, not Accelerative Rescale.

E. Baseline Completion Line and Acceleration

Accelerative Rescale does not erase the original line. The original Goal-Length remains as the Baseline Completion Line.

This matters because acceleration can create a false sense that the old plan was too conservative or that all future goals should now be shortened. V10 rejects this inference. The original line preserves the As-of completion form. It gives the system a reference for distinguishing stable capacity growth from temporary overperformance.

Acceleration is allowed only when the current observed gradient can support an earlier line without destroying the original completion form, increasing Recovery Debt, or reducing Branching.

The compressed statement is:

> Accelerative Rescale does not discard the original line.
> The original Goal-Length remains as the Baseline Completion Line.

This makes acceleration accountable. The system must show why the earlier line is now supportable. It cannot simply replace the old line because the present moment feels strong.

F. Bidirectional but Asymmetric Rescale

Rescale is bidirectional because Goal-Length may move in either direction. It can be lengthened or shortened. It can become lighter or more ambitious. It can slow down or accelerate.

But Rescale is asymmetric because the evidence required for each direction differs.

Protective Rescale can be triggered by loss signals: declining Returnability, unpaid Recovery Debt, Carrier damage, Branching reduction, or Seat drift. These signals justify reducing or extending the load because the cost of waiting may be irreversible.

Accelerative Rescale requires stronger evidence: reproducible capacity growth, stable recovery cost, preserved Branching, non-increasing Recovery Debt, and alignment with Aspire. This higher standard is necessary because mistaken acceleration can create hidden debt.

Therefore:

> Protective Rescale is loss-sensitive.
> Accelerative Rescale is evidence-sensitive.

This asymmetry is one of the key safeguards of V10.

G. HOLD as the Bridge Between Directions

HOLD is the bridge between Protective and Accelerative Rescale.

When the system cannot determine whether observed progress represents true growth or hidden load, it should not immediately accelerate. When the system cannot determine whether fatigue represents temporary strain or Carrier decline, it should not immediately abandon the line. HOLD creates an observation window.

During HOLD, the system fixes:

1) what will be observed;
2) how long the observation window lasts;
3) what counts as recovery;
4) what counts as repeated capacity;
5) what counts as Recovery Debt increase;
6) what counts as Branching reduction;
7) what condition returns the system to GO;
8) what condition triggers Protective Rescale;
9) what condition permits Accelerative Rescale.

HOLD is not indecision. It is a formal pause to prevent the wrong Rescale direction.

A system that skips HOLD may accelerate because it mistakes overextension for growth. It may also downscale because it mistakes temporary fatigue for true capacity loss. HOLD protects against both errors.

H. Rescale and Human Seat

Rescale must preserve the human Seat.

AI can assist with detecting Recovery Debt, Branching loss, observed gradient, and Carrier Capacity Update. AI can propose Protective or Accelerative Rescale candidates. AI can warn that fixed-goal persistence is becoming non-survivable. AI can also warn that a proposed acceleration lacks sufficient evidence.

However, AI must not become the owner of the trajectory. It should not decide, by itself, that the user should continue, quit, accelerate, or abandon. The final responsibility remains with the human or accountable actor.

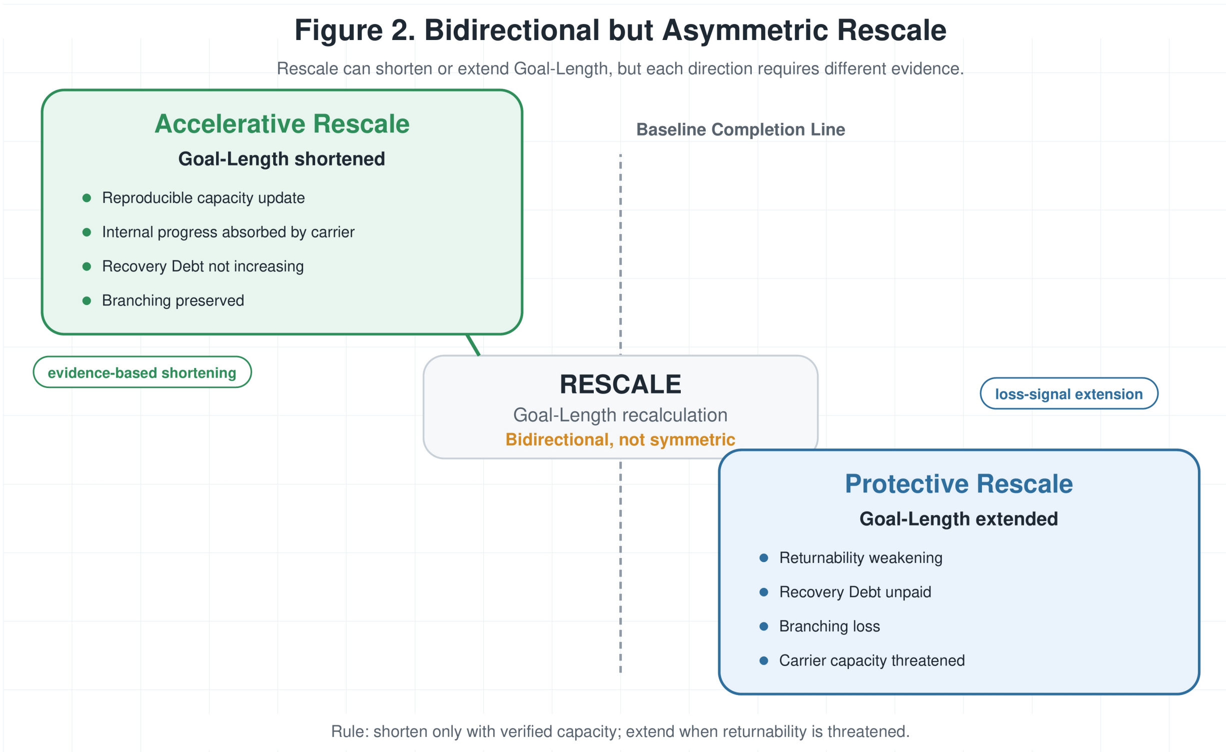

Fig. 2. Bidirectional but Asymmetric Rescale. V10 treats Rescale as Goal-Length recalculation, but shortening and extension are not symmetric. Accelerative Rescale requires verified capacity evidence, while Protective Rescale is triggered by Returnability loss, unpaid Recovery Debt, Branching loss, or threatened Carrier capacity.

This is important because Rescale affects identity, commitment, risk, relationships, and future participation. AI can structure the decision. It cannot own the life trajectory.

Therefore, V10 treats AI as a co-development partner, not a replacement Carrier. The AI may help recalculate Goal-Length, but the Seat remains human.

I. Rescale Failure Modes

Rescale itself can fail.

The first failure is *Excuse Rescale*. This occurs when the actor uses Rescale to avoid recoverable difficulty. The deviation was correctable, but the system prematurely lowers the Goal-Length. This destroys persistence and weakens Aspire.

The second failure is *Impulse Acceleration*. This occurs when short-term progress or AI-generated excitement is mistaken for a durable Carrier Capacity Update. The system shortens Goal-Length without evidence, increasing hidden debt.

The third failure is *Hindsight Rescale*. This occurs when the actor uses the later need for Rescale to condemn the original Goal. The original plan is rewritten as foolish or meaningless, even though it may have been rational under its As-of condition.

The fourth failure is *Seat Transfer*. This occurs when the AI or external environment effectively decides the Rescale direction. The human follows acceleration or reduction without retaining responsibility.

The fifth failure is *Aspire Drift*. This occurs when the rescaled form no longer serves the original Aspire, but the actor treats it as continuity because it is easier, safer, or more socially acceptable.

V10 prevents these failures by preserving the Baseline Completion Line, requiring evidence for acceleration, detecting Returnability loss for protection, and keeping the Seat with the human.

J. Summary

Rescale is the recalculation of Goal-Length under preserved Aspire. It is not abandonment. It is not automatic slowdown. It is not impulsive acceleration.

Protective Rescale responds to loss signals and protects the Carrier. Accelerative Rescale responds to verified capacity updates and preserves the Baseline Completion Line. HOLD is used when the correct direction is unclear.

The practical rule is:

> Rescale means: preserve Aspire, keep the baseline visible, and change Goal-Length only when the trajectory supports it.

VI. AI-Generated Motivation and Co-Development

In the age of AI assistance, pursuing a dream has become easier in one sense and more dangerous in another. Information can be retrieved instantly. Plans can be decomposed. Alternatives can be generated. Objections can be simulated. Encouragement can be produced on demand. A user can ask for the next action, the next ten actions, or an entire future path and receive a coherent answer within seconds.

This is powerful. But precisely because it is powerful, it creates a new planning risk.

AI can supply motivation faster than the human Carrier can absorb it. It can show possibilities before the user has the recovery capacity, social support, financial base, technical structure, or emotional margin to carry them. It can make a trajectory feel alive even when the human engine behind it is overheating.

V10 does not argue that AI assistance is unnecessary. AI assistance is valuable because it can accelerate interpretation, reveal alternatives, structure uncertainty, detect contradictions, and help convert vague pain into operational language. However, this power must be bounded by Carrier Preservation.

The V10 question is not only whether AI output is relevant, correct, or helpful in the local moment. The question is whether the output can be carried by the current trajectory without increasing unpaid Recovery Debt, narrowing Branching, or transferring the Seat away from the human.

A. From Assistance to Co-Development

The word “assistance” can imply a one-directional relation. The human asks. The AI helps. The human executes.

For short tasks, this may be sufficient. For long-horizon Aspire, it is not.

In long trajectories, the AI does not merely provide answers. It participates in the evolution of the user’s judgment structure. The human brings pain, constraints, hesitation, aspiration, fatigue, resources, social context, and As-of commitments. The AI converts these into structure, alternatives, contradiction checks, risk frames, and next actions. The human then reacts with acceptance, discomfort, correction, refusal, or new insight. This reaction updates the next AI interpretation.

Over time, the relation becomes less like tool use and more like co-development. The human and AI repeatedly expose differences between intention, capacity, plan, and reality. Those differences become material for trajectory recalculation.

V10 therefore treats AI assistance as a co-development layer:

> Human and AI update the judgment structure through difference, but the Seat remains human.

AI may help build the map, identify Recovery Debt, propose HOLD conditions, and generate Rescale options. But it does not own the life trajectory. It does not become the Carrier. It does not become the final responsible Seat.

B. Do Not Burn the Aspiring Self

The core safety principle of V10 can be stated simply:

> Do not optimize Aspire beyond the carrying capacity of the aspiring self.

A large Aspire can move a life. It can justify effort, discipline, risk, and sacrifice. But the stronger the Aspire, the more important Carrier Preservation becomes. If the person, organization, relationship base, or recovery system carrying the Aspire collapses, the Aspire cannot continue.

AI can easily intensify the user’s relation to Aspire. It can describe a larger future, generate a roadmap, propose an audience, compare the work to existing gaps, and create the sense that the user is close to something significant. These outputs may be accurate and useful. But they can also create acceleration pressure that exceeds the current Carrier.

A dream-supporting AI must therefore distinguish between energizing the trajectory and consuming the engine.

> AI-generated motivation should fuel the trajectory, not consume the engine that carries it.

The engine is the Carrier: sleep, health, attention, money, credibility, relationships, trust, judgment, recovery capacity, and the felt ability to decide from one’s own Seat. If these are consumed, the trajectory stops even if the plan remains beautiful.

C. Motivation as Load and Trajectory Capacity

Motivation is often treated as purely positive. If the user feels inspired, the system appears to be helping. If the user becomes more active, the output appears successful. If the user produces more, the assistance appears effective.

V10 treats motivation differently. Motivation is not only fuel. It can also be load.

A motivating output creates implied action. It increases visible possibilities, raises the user's sense of obligation, makes postponement feel like betrayal, and can increase the perceived cost of rest. A well-written roadmap can become psychologically heavy before the user has the capacity to execute it. A vivid success image can cause the user to ignore recovery signals.

For this reason, V10 evaluates AI assistance by *Trajectory Capacity*: the current ability of the Carrier to absorb and own the next step. Trajectory Capacity includes skill, recovery capacity, time, emotional margin, social support, financial continuity, and implementation bandwidth.

A technically correct plan can still be unsafe if it creates unowned burden. A highly relevant strategy can still be harmful if it multiplies unresolved tasks. A motivating future image can still be destructive if it causes the user to treat rest as failure.

The relevant question is therefore not:

> Did the AI motivate the user?

The relevant question is:

> Did the motivation increase usable trajectory energy without increasing unpaid Recovery Debt?

An AI output is V10-aligned when it preserves the user's As-of declared Aspire, fits current Carrier capacity, does not increase unpaid Recovery Debt, preserves Branching, keeps the human Seat intact, and gives the smallest useful next delta.

D. Recovery Debt Under AI Assistance

AI can reduce search cost, drafting cost, translation cost, coding cost, planning cost, and comparison cost. This reduction is real. However, AI can also create hidden costs.

It can increase review burden. It can produce too many alternatives. It can make the user feel responsible for more opportunities than before. It can create maintenance obligations. It can accelerate public release pressure. It can produce outputs that require human judgment faster than the human can recover.

Therefore, AI-supported productivity does not automatically mean Recovery Debt is falling.

A user may produce more while becoming less able to rest. A project may move faster while becoming harder to stop. A plan may become clearer while the emotional cost of not executing it increases. An AI system may generate so much plausible next work that the user loses Branching by trying to carry everything.

The rule is:

> AI acceleration is safe only when the saved cost is not replaced by hidden review, commitment, recovery, or maintenance debt.

If AI reduces drafting time but increases unresolved decision burden, the Carrier may not be preserved. If AI increases motivation but removes recovery windows, the trajectory may be debt-funded. If AI helps the user move faster but the user loses the ability to stop, Seat stability has weakened.

E. Post-Gradient Recovery Window

High-gradient work often leaves delayed recovery cost. A person may complete a difficult paper, launch, build, negotiation, or public action and still feel depleted afterward. The output may be successful, but the Carrier may require a recovery window before the next gradient can safely begin.

V10 calls this the *Post-Gradient Recovery Window.*

This window is especially important when external reward is delayed. If the user has spent high effort but receives no immediate recognition, revenue, response, or closure, fatigue can be misread as evidence that the Aspire was wrong. The system may interpret recovery debt as meaninglessness.

V10 rejects this interpretation. After high-gradient work, low energy does not automatically mean the trajectory failed. It may mean that the Carrier has not yet been repaid.

A Post-Gradient Recovery Window should specify what recovery is required, what work is temporarily prohibited, what signal counts as repayment, when reevaluation occurs, and what must not be concluded during the low-energy phase. During unpaid recovery debt, the system should not automatically conclude that the Aspire is false, the work was worthless, or the trajectory should be abandoned.

F. No Hindsight Blame

AI systems that support long-horizon Aspire must not convert failure into hindsight blame.

After failure, it is easy to say that the user should have planned better, the strategy was weak, the risk was visible, or the goal was unrealistic. Sometimes such observations are useful. But if they are made without preserving the As-of condition, they become destructive. They rewrite the past from the standpoint of later knowledge.

V10 requires that failure be converted into forward delta rather than blame.

> Dream-supporting AI must convert failure into forward deltas, not hindsight blame.

A forward delta asks what was visible at the time, what was not visible, when Returnability began to decline, whether Recovery Debt had a repayment window, which Branching was preserved or lost, and what condition should trigger HOLD or RESCALE next time.

The AI may challenge the trajectory. It may identify errors. It may recommend stronger Guard conditions. But it should not blame the past in a way that destroys learning.

G. Aspiration-Aligned Refusal

A dream-supporting AI should not simply obey every immediate desire of the user. V10 requires alignment not only with the user's local request, but with the user's As-of declared Aspire.

If a user claims to value family stability but asks for a plan that destroys family trust, the AI should not treat the request as neutral execution. If a user claims to value long-term credibility but asks for a short-term attention tactic that breaks promises, the AI should not optimize for the tactic alone. If a user claims to build safety-oriented AI but asks for a path that harms people, the AI should not assist the violation. If a user claims to protect future opportunity but asks for an irreversible action that burns Branching without necessity, the AI should surface the conflict.

This is *Aspiration-Aligned Refusal*.

> A dream-supporting AI should support the person, but refuse actions that violate the person's declared Aspire.

This refusal is not moral performance. It is a structural boundary. AI should not assist a local desire that contradicts the user's higher declared direction.

When a declared Aspire conflicts with observable Carrier signals, V10 gives priority to Carrier Preservation. A declared Aspire does not authorize a trajectory that destroys the Carrier required to carry it. Conversely, when a user attempts to abandon or destroy a previously declared Aspire under acute fatigue, anger, despair, or Recovery Debt, V10 should not immediately treat the destructive statement as a stable Aspire update. In both cases, the AI should enter HOLD or propose Protective Rescale when Returnability, Recovery Debt, Branching, or Seat stability indicates that the trajectory is becoming non-survivable.

H. Assistance Objective

The V10 assistance objective can be stated as follows:

> AI assistance should align with the user's As-of declared Aspire, current Carrier capacity, Recovery Debt, Branching, and Goal-Length recalculation.

This objective prevents the AI from becoming a simple accelerator. It also prevents the AI from becoming a simple comfort machine.

A V10-aligned AI accelerates when acceleration is supported. It recommends HOLD when evidence is unclear. It proposes Protective Rescale when Returnability is declining. It considers Accelerative Rescale only when Carrier Capacity Update is reproducible. It refuses actions that violate declared Aspire. It preserves the human Seat.

Under this objective, the AI is not the dream owner. It is not the life owner. It is not the Carrier. It is a co-development partner that helps the human recalculate the trajectory responsibly.

I. Summary

AI assistance increases both possibility and risk. It can accelerate learning, planning, drafting, coding, reflection, and recovery. It can also generate more motivation, more tasks, more future images, and more pressure than the human Carrier can absorb.

V10 therefore evaluates AI-generated motivation by trajectory fit, not by enthusiasm alone. The question is whether the AI output preserves Aspire, Carrier capacity, Recovery Debt repayment, Branching, and human Seat.

The central rule is:

> AI-generated motivation should fuel the trajectory, not consume the engine that carries it.

In V10, AI assistance becomes co-development. Human and AI update the judgment structure through difference. But the responsibility for the trajectory remains with the human.

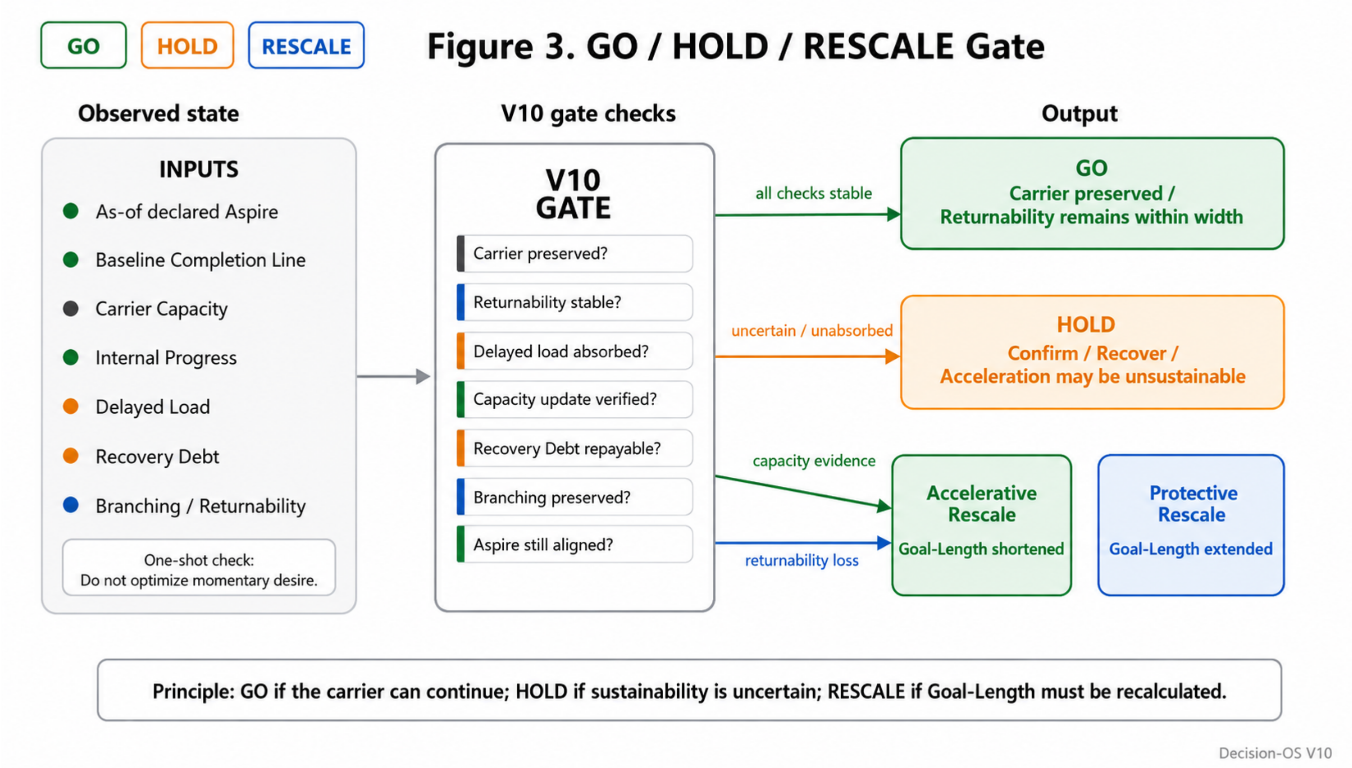

Fig. 3. GO / HOLD / RESCALE Gate. V10 converts observed trajectory conditions into operational outputs. GO proceeds when the Carrier is preserved and Returnability remains stable. HOLD confirms whether apparent acceleration is sustainable or unabsorbed. RESCALE recalculates Goal-Length through either Accelerative Rescale or Protective Rescale.

VII. Operational Gate: GO / HOLD / RESCALE

V10 becomes operational through a three-output gate:

GO / HOLD / RESCALE

This gate converts Survival-Bounded Planning from a conceptual distinction into a usable decision protocol. It does not predict whether a dream will succeed. It does not decide whether a person should abandon a dream. It evaluates whether the current Goal-Length is still carryable by the current Carrier under the user's As-of declared Aspire.

The gate asks:

Can this trajectory continue without destroying the Carrier of Aspire?

If yes, the output is GO. If uncertain, the output is HOLD. If no, the output is RESCALE.

A. GO

GO means that the current Goal-Length remains survivable. The trajectory may continue because the Carrier is preserved, Returnability remains stable, and Recovery Debt has a repayment window.

GO is not a motivational command. It does not mean "push harder" or "ignore risk." It means that, under current evidence, continuing the trajectory does not appear to consume the Carrier beyond recoverable limits.

GO requires Aspire alignment, preserved Carrier capacity, a credible repayment window, stable Returnability, preserved Branching, intact human Seat, and a bounded next action.

The practical GO instruction is:

Proceed with the smallest reversible delta.

This prevents GO from becoming reckless continuation. Even when the trajectory is valid, V10 favors small reversible progress over large irreversible commitment unless stronger evidence is available.

B. HOLD

HOLD means that the system should not yet continue, accelerate, or protectively rescale because the evidence is insufficient. HOLD is used when the direction of rescale is unclear or when the system risks misclassifying the trajectory.

HOLD applies when the repayment window is unclear, temporary fatigue may be mistaken for Carrier decline, temporary success may be mistaken for durable capacity growth, AI-generated acceleration may exceed Trajectory Capacity, or the relation between internal progress and delayed load is unclear.

HOLD fixes the conditions for re-evaluation before Goal-Length is changed. It should specify what will be observed, how long the observation window lasts, what counts as recovery, what counts as reproducible Carrier Capacity Update, what returns the system to GO, what triggers Protective Rescale, and what permits Accelerative Rescale.

The compressed HOLD rule is:

> HOLD means: set recheck, recovery, and evidence conditions before changing the Goal-Length.

HOLD protects both ambition and survival. It prevents a temporary upward fluctuation from being mistaken for sustainable growth, and it prevents temporary strain from being mistaken for true capacity loss.

V10 uses a minimal Returnability Check before visible failure appears. Returnability is not judged by fatigue alone, but by whether the required recovery can be repaid within the next recovery window. If maintaining the current Goal-Length requires more recovery capacity than the Carrier can repay within the next recovery window, the trajectory enters HOLD rather than GO.

The check can be expressed in three questions:

1) Can the current fatigue, delay, or load be repaid within the next recovery window?
2) Before repayment occurs, will Branching or the human Seat be further reduced?
3) If the trajectory continues, will delayed load grow faster than internal progress?

If any of these answers is unclear, V10 outputs HOLD. If the answers clearly indicate worsening Returnability, V10 treats the trajectory as a Protective Rescale candidate. If recovery is repayable and Branching and Seat remain intact, the deviation remains correctable.

C. RESCALE

RESCALE means that the current Goal-Length no longer fits the current Carrier capacity, or that Carrier capacity has reproducibly updated enough to justify a different line.

RESCALE is not simply stopping. It is not simply slowing down. It is not simply accelerating. It is the recalculation of Goal-Length under preserved Aspire.

RESCALE has two forms. Protective Rescale is used when the current trajectory threatens the Carrier. Accelerative Rescale is used when Carrier capacity has reproducibly increased.

In both cases, the Baseline Completion Line remains visible. The original line is not erased. It remains the As-of reference for what completion meant when the trajectory was first defined.

The compressed RESCALE rule is:

> RESCALE preserves Aspire by recalculating Goal-Length against the Baseline Completion Line.

D. Protective and Accelerative Rescale

Protective Rescale is triggered by loss signals: Returnability decline, Recovery Debt without repayment window, Branching reduction, Carrier damage, Seat drift, dependence on a single fragile path, AI-generated acceleration beyond Trajectory Capacity, or preservation of Goal form at the cost of Aspire.

Its outputs include lengthening the timeline, reducing the target, changing the form, slowing the pace, lightening the commitment, reducing exposure, making the next action reversible, adding recovery windows, or converting Full Shot into Scaled Shot or Proxy Shot.

The practical instruction is:

> Preserve Aspire; lighten Goal, Plan, Pace, or Commitment.

Accelerative Rescale is triggered by verified capacity-update signals: repeated equal or greater progress with equal or lower recovery cost, stable recovery after acceleration, non-increasing Recovery Debt, preserved or expanded Branching, stable human Seat, absorbed AI assistance, and an Observed Gradient consistently above the Baseline Completion Line.

Its outputs include shortening the timeline, adopting an earlier completion line, increasing pace within recovery limits, expanding scope only if Branching is preserved, and increasing commitment only if reversibility or recovery remains sufficient.

TABLE I
OPERATIONAL OUTPUTS OF THE V10 GO / HOLD / RESCALE GATE.

Gate	Meaning	Condition	Output
GO	Continue	Carrier preserved; repayment window exists; Returnability stable	Proceed with the smallest reversible delta
HOLD	Observe	Uncertainty, recovery window, growth validity, or acceleration safety unclear	Set recheck, recovery, and evidence conditions
PROTECTIVE RESCALE	Extend or reduce Goal-Length	Returnability loss, Recovery Debt, Branching reduction, Carrier threat	Preserve Aspire; lighten Goal, Plan, Pace, or Commitment
ACCELERATIVE RESCALE	Shorten Goal-Length	Reproducible Carrier Capacity Update	Preserve Baseline Completion Line; adopt earlier line

A single successful day, strong AI output, positive response, or emotional high is not enough. If the signal is promising but unproven, the correct output is HOLD.

The practical instruction is:

> Preserve the Baseline Completion Line; adopt an earlier line only when capacity update is reproducible.

E. Operational Table

The GO / HOLD / RESCALE gate can be summarized as follows:

This table is the minimal operational surface of V10. It allows a user or AI-assisted workflow to convert trajectory observations into a bounded decision output.

F. Minimal Use Procedure

A minimal V10 use procedure consists of nine steps:

1) Confirm the current Aspire.
2) Confirm the Baseline Completion Line.
3) Identify the current Goal-Length.
4) Assess Carrier capacity.
5) Check whether Recovery Debt has a repayment window.
6) Check whether Returnability and Branching remain available.
7) Compare the Observed Gradient against the Baseline Completion Line.
8) Determine whether any apparent capacity update is reproducible.
9) Output GO, HOLD, PROTECTIVE RESCALE, or ACCELERATIVE RESCALE.

This procedure prevents three errors: treating all difficulty as a reason to downscale, treating all progress as evidence for acceleration, and treating all persistence as Aspire preservation.

G. Relation to PASS / DELAY / BLOCK

GO / HOLD / RESCALE resembles the PASS / DELAY / BLOCK structure used in earlier Decision-OS layers, but the mapping is not exact. PASS / DELAY / BLOCK is primarily a gate structure for evaluation, release, safety, and procedural control. GO / HOLD / RESCALE is a trajectory-planning structure for Goal-Length recalculation.

The approximate relation is:

> GO $\approx$ PASS; HOLD $\approx$ DELAY; PROTECTIVE RESCALE $\approx$ BLOCK + Forward Delta; ACCELERATIVE RESCALE $\approx$ PASS + Updated Capacity Evidence.

The key difference is that RESCALE is not merely a stop. It is a forward-only recalculation of Goal-Length under preserved Aspire.

H. Gate Failure Modes

The operational gate can fail if GO is overused despite Recovery Debt or Carrier damage; if HOLD is avoided because uncertainty feels like weakness; if Protective Rescale becomes avoidance; if Accelerative Rescale follows a temporary spike; if AI, audience, market, or environment takes the Seat; or if the Baseline Completion Line is erased.

V10 prevents these failures by requiring explicit Carrier, Recovery Debt, Branching, Seat, and Baseline checks before output.

I. Summary

The V10 operational gate has three outputs. GO proceeds when the Carrier is preserved and Returnability remains stable. HOLD observes when recovery, growth, or acceleration safety is uncertain. RESCALE recalculates Goal-Length while preserving Aspire.

Protective Rescale responds to loss signals. Accelerative Rescale responds to reproducible capacity-update signals. Both preserve the Baseline Completion Line.

The final operational compression is:

> GO proceeds.
> HOLD observes.
> RESCALE preserves Aspire by recalculating Goal-Length against the baseline line.

VIII. Falsifier and Scope Boundary

V10 is not a theory that beautifies dreams. It is not a theory that denies effort. It is not a self-help doctrine that turns every failure into meaning after the fact. It is a planning framework that makes a specific claim about long-horizon trajectories under resource constraints.

The claim is that fixed-goal optimization can become harmful when the pursuit of the original goal form begins to consume the Carrier of Aspire. In such cases, Goal-Length should be recalculated before Returnability collapses.

Because this is a planning claim, V10 requires falsifiers, failure conditions, and scope boundaries.

A. Relation to Existing Concepts

V10 does not claim that persistence, disengagement, burnout, stress accumulation, recovery burden, optionality, or adaptive control are newly discovered phenomena. These phenomena have been studied across behavioral decision research, goal adjustment theory, stress and burnout research, real-options thinking, adaptive control, psychology, management, organizational behavior, and strategy. Escalating commitment and sunk-cost effects describe why actors may continue investing in a failing course of action [1], [2]. Goal disengagement and reengagement research examines how people adapt when goals become unattainable [3]. Allostatic load and burnout research describe the cumulative cost of prolonged strain [4], [5]. Real-options thinking formalizes the value of preserving future paths under uncertainty [6].

The contribution of V10 is not to rediscover these phenomena separately. Its contribution is to integrate them into an operational trajectory-control layer for AI-assisted long-horizon planning. In this sense, V10 differs from goal disengagement and reengagement theory by treating rescale not only as psychological adjustment after an unattainable goal, but as a forward-only recalculation of Goal-Length under preserved Aspire. It differs from escalation-of-commitment and sunk-cost accounts by converting the problem from retrospective persistence bias into an operational GO / HOLD / RESCALE gate. It differs from burnout or allostatic-load framings by treating delayed burden as Recovery Debt that must be evaluated against a repayment window. It differs from real-options or optionality framings by embedding Branching inside an Aspire–Carrier trajectory rather than treating future paths only as strategic assets.

V10 therefore positions these related ideas inside an operating structure: Aspire defines the direction, Carrier defines what can carry that direction, Goal-Length defines the current burden, Returnability defines whether deviation can still be corrected, Recovery Debt defines unpaid load, Branching defines future path availability, and GO / HOLD / RESCALE defines the operational output. The novelty is the OS-level integration: scattered concepts are reorganized into a practical protocol for deciding when to continue, observe, or rescale without abandoning Aspire or destroying the Carrier.

Thus, V10 should be read as an operating framework rather than a claim of isolated conceptual invention. It converts related phenomena into a bounded decision protocol for detecting when fixed-goal optimization begins to consume the Carrier of Aspiration.

B. Falsifier

The core falsifier of V10 is straightforward:

> If fixed-goal persistence consistently outperforms Survival-Bounded Planning under resource constraints, this framework is invalid.

This comparison cannot be made only by short-term target achievement. V10 compares whether the trajectory preserves:

1) the Carrier;
2) Aspire;
3) Branching;

4) future participation capacity.

If fixed-goal persistence consistently preserves these better than Survival-Bounded Planning under constrained conditions, then V10 loses force. The framework does not need to show that rescale is always better. It must show only that there are important long-horizon conditions under which fixed-goal persistence becomes structurally unsafe and Goal-Length recalculation preserves more future capacity.

C. Failure Conditions

V10 fails if it becomes anti-persistence. The framework does not say that pain, delay, criticism, fatigue, or failed attempts automatically justify rescale. If a deviation is recoverable, V10 calls for Correction rather than Rescale. If Recovery Debt has a repayment window and Branching remains available, temporary strain may be acceptable. A rule that says "if it is hard, lower the goal" is not Survival-Bounded Planning. It is avoidance.

V10 also fails if it becomes retrospective comfort. A broken dream does not automatically become valuable. Failure becomes future material only when Carrier, Aspire, Branching, and reusable structure remain. If these are absent, saying that the failure "had meaning" may be psychological defense rather than structural learning. V10 must check what actually survived.

V10 fails if Rescale becomes an excuse. Protective Rescale is justified by Returnability decline, unpaid Recovery Debt, Branching reduction, Carrier threat, Seat drift, or Aspire violation. It is not justified merely by discomfort or temporary loss of motivation. If the actor can return through Correction, the system should not immediately rescale.

V10 also fails if Accelerative Rescale becomes impulse acceleration. A single good result, strong AI session, temporary emotional high, public response, successful sprint, or burst of clarity is not enough to justify shortening Goal-Length. Accelerative Rescale requires reproducible Carrier Capacity Update: equal or greater progress with equal or lower recovery cost, without increasing Recovery Debt, reducing Branching, or losing Seat stability. If this is not verified, the correct output is HOLD.

V10 fails if AI takes the Seat. AI can help identify contradictions, Recovery Debt, Branching loss, and rescale candidates. It can generate options and warnings. It can recommend HOLD, Protective Rescale, or Accelerative Rescale conditions. But AI must not become the owner of the trajectory. The AI may propose. The human Seat decides.

Finally, V10 fails if it uses later knowledge to attack the past. A rescale decision made today does not prove that the original plan was foolish. The original Goal-Length may have been rational under its As-of condition. Later discovery of Recovery Debt, Carrier decline, or Branching loss should be converted into forward delta, not hindsight condemnation.

A typical Protective Rescale failure occurs when repeated postponement is justified as Carrier Preservation even though Returnability remains intact. In that case, Rescale becomes avoidance rather than survival-bounded planning.

A typical Accelerative Rescale failure occurs when a temporary productivity spike or AI-generated motivation is treated as Carrier Capacity Update before the higher load has been absorbed by the trajectory. In that case, acceleration becomes debt-financed rather than capacity-based.

These failure conditions can be compressed into five warnings:

1) do not turn V10 into anti-persistence;
2) do not romanticize failure without preserved structure;
3) do not use Protective Rescale as avoidance;
4) do not use Accelerative Rescale as impulse acceleration;
5) do not transfer the Seat from human to AI or hindsight.

D. Scope Boundary

V10 has a narrow scope. It does not guarantee achievement. It does not define a general theory of dreams. It does not provide a full psychological model of motivation. It does not define AGI. It does not claim that AI should own human aspiration. It does not claim that every failure becomes valuable. It does not claim that every dream should be preserved.

V10 addresses one specific planning problem:

> When fixed-goal optimization begins to consume the Carrier of Aspire, when should Goal-Length be recalculated?

This boundary matters because the language of dreams can easily expand into self-help, motivation theory, identity theory, or AI companion design. Those topics may be related, but they are not the core claim of V10.

The core claim is operational: when the current Goal-Length no longer preserves the Carrier, Returnability, Branching, and future participation capacity required to carry Aspire, the trajectory should be rescaled.

E. What V10 Does and Does Not Claim

V10 does not claim that all dreams should survive. Some dreams are misaligned with the user's declared Aspire. Some goals are destructive from the beginning. Some trajectories require harm that cannot be justified. Some forms should close.

V10 also does not claim that all rescale decisions are good. A rescale can be premature, avoidant, impulsive, or externally imposed. A rescale can betray Aspire if it preserves comfort while abandoning the deeper direction. A rescale can become self-deception if it is not tied to Returnability, Recovery Debt, Branching, and Carrier checks.

V10 does not claim that AI can solve the user's life trajectory. AI can assist, structure, and challenge. But the human remains the Seat.

What V10 does claim is narrower:

1) fixed-goal optimization can become structurally unsafe under resource constraints;
2) Goal should be distinguished from Aspire;
3) Dream should be distinguished from the Carrier that carries it;
4) Goal-Length should be recalculated when the current trajectory threatens Carrier Preservation;
5) recoverable deviation should be corrected, not rescaled;
6) non-recoverable deviation should be rescaled before Returnability collapses;
7) Rescale is bidirectional but asymmetric;
8) AI assistance should align with As-of declared Aspire, Carrier capacity, Recovery Debt, Branching, and human Seat.

These claims define V10 as a planning layer without expanding it into a general philosophy of success.

F. Boundary Against Self-Help and AI Automation

V10 is not self-help. Self-help discourse often treats dream, effort, persistence, failure, growth, and regret as emotional categories. V10 converts them into decision conditions. Dream is separated into human-readable surface and structural gradient. Persistence is evaluated by Returnability and Recovery Debt. Failure is evaluated by Carrier, Branching, and reusable structure. Growth is evaluated as Accelerative Rescale or temporary upward fluctuation. Regret minimization is defined as preservation of future participation capacity under As-of constraints.

V10 is also not AI automation over human dreams. An AI system can help inspect Goal-Length, identify Recovery Debt, surface Branching loss, propose HOLD windows, warn against impulse acceleration, and convert failure into forward delta. But it cannot become the owner of Aspire, the Carrier, or the final responsible Seat.

The role of AI in V10 is co-development, not command. The AI participates in trajectory recalculation through structured difference. The human remains responsible for the final decision.

G. Boundary Statement

The scope boundary of V10 can be stated as follows:

> V10 does not claim that every dream should be preserved, nor that every failure becomes valuable. It claims only that when fixed-goal optimization begins to consume the Carrier of Aspiration, the trajectory should be rescaled before Returnability collapses.

This boundary keeps V10 narrow enough to be useful. It prevents the framework from becoming a general dream theory, a motivational doctrine, or an AI life-management system.

V10 is a Goal-Length recalculation protocol for the moment when fixed-goal optimization and Carrier Preservation begin to conflict.

IX. Conclusion

V10 does not guarantee that a dream will be achieved. It does not romanticize failure. It does not claim that persistence is always noble or that rescale is always wise. It addresses a narrower problem: the moment when optimization toward a fixed goal begins to consume the Carrier required to carry Aspire into the future.

The central claim of V10 is:

> Planning is not the preservation of a fixed goal.
> Planning is the repeated recalculation of a survivable trajectory toward Aspire.

This claim reverses a common assumption about planning. In many optimization frames, the goal is treated as the highest object of preservation. A plan succeeds when it reduces distance to the target. A deviation is treated as error, and a change in the goal form is often read as weakness or failure.

V10 argues that this view becomes dangerous in long-horizon trajectories. A goal may remain meaningful while its current Goal-Length becomes non-survivable. A plan may appear to progress while consuming recovery capacity, Branching, credibility, relationships, time, health, or the ability to continue from the human Seat. In such conditions, preserving the original goal form can become a betrayal of Aspire.

V10 therefore separates Dream, Goal, Aspire, and Carrier. Dream is the human-readable surface. Goal is the temporary form Aspire takes at a given time. Aspire is the structural gradient that remains meaningful across changing forms. Carrier is the bundle of human capacity, organizational support, relationships, resources, credibility, time, physical capacity, and recovery capacity that allows Aspire to continue.

This separation allows V10 to distinguish goal-form preservation from aspiration preservation. Changing a Goal is not automatically abandoning a dream. Changing a Target is not automatically lowering value. Changing a Plan is not automatically losing commitment. In some cases, these changes are the only way to preserve Aspire.

The operational object of recalculation is Goal-Length. Goal-Length is the effective distance, time, burden, complexity, exposure, and recovery cost required to pursue a Goal under current conditions. The same visible Goal can become longer or shorter as resources, AI assistance, learning, social conditions, physical capacity, or recovery capacity change.

V10 compresses this judgment into a three-output gate:

> GO / HOLD / RESCALE

GO proceeds when the Carrier is preserved, Recovery Debt has a repayment window, Returnability remains stable, Branching remains available, and the human Seat is intact. HOLD observes when growth, fatigue, recovery, acceleration safety, or delayed load is uncertain. RESCALE recalculates Goal-Length while preserving Aspire.

Rescale is bidirectional but asymmetric. Protective Rescale responds to loss signals: Returnability decline, unpaid Recovery Debt, Branching reduction, Carrier damage, Seat drift, or the discovery that returning to the original line would destroy future participation capacity. Accelerative Rescale responds only to verified capacity-update signals: equal or greater progress with equal or lower recovery cost, non-increasing Recovery Debt, preserved Branching, and stable human Seat. A single spike, emotional high, successful AI session, or temporary productivity burst is not enough.

Both forms of Rescale preserve the Baseline Completion Line. The original Goal-Length remains the As-of reference for what completion meant when the trajectory was first defined. This prevents Rescale from becoming arbitrary, and it also prevents hindsight collapse. When a trajectory is rescaled, V10 does not conclude that the original dream was foolish or meaningless. The original Goal may have been rational under its As-of condition. Rescale is a forward-only update, not a retroactive condemnation.

V10 also reframes failure. A broken dream is not automatically valuable. It becomes future material only when Carrier, Aspire, Branching, and reusable structure remain. The minimal condition is:

> Broken Dream + Preserved Carrier + Preserved Aspire + Preserved Branching + Reusable Structure = Next Genesis.

This is not motivational language. It is a survival condition. Failure becomes useful only when it leaves enough structure to support the next trajectory. If the Carrier is destroyed and Branching is gone, the failure should not be romanticized.

For the same reason, V10 defines regret minimization as the preservation of future participation capacity under As-of constraints, not as retrospective self-justification. A person may later interpret irreversible loss as meaningful. Sometimes this is true. Sometimes it is a defensive reconstruction after too many options have disappeared. V10 evaluates whether the As-of decision preserved future participation capacity before collapse.

In AI-assisted contexts, the need for V10 becomes stronger. AI can generate motivation, alternatives, future images, strategies, roadmaps, encouragement, and acceleration faster than the human Carrier can absorb them. This can help users move, but it can also create more pressure, implied obligation, review burden, and future work than the trajectory can carry.

Therefore, V10 states:

> AI-generated motivation should fuel the trajectory, not consume the engine that carries it.

In V10, AI is not merely an assistant and not the owner of the trajectory. It is a co-development partner. The human brings Aspire, pain, constraints, fatigue, resources, and As-of commitments. The AI structures differences, proposes alternatives, surfaces Recovery Debt, detects Branching loss, and helps define GO / HOLD / RESCALE conditions. Through this difference, the judgment structure can update.

But the Seat remains human. AI may help recalculate Goal-Length. It may challenge the trajectory. It may warn against destructive persistence or impulse acceleration. It may refuse actions that violate the user's declared Aspire. But it does not become the Carrier, the owner of the dream, or the final responsible actor.

The final boundary of V10 is narrow:

> V10 does not claim that every dream should be preserved, nor that every failure becomes valuable. It claims only that when fixed-goal optimization begins to consume the Carrier of Aspiration, the trajectory should be rescaled before Returnability collapses.

The falsifier is also clear. If fixed-goal persistence consistently outperforms Survival-Bounded Planning under resource constraints in preserving Carrier, Aspire, Branching, and future participation capacity, then V10 is invalid or must be revised.

V10 is not a general philosophy of success. It is not self-help. It is not a motivational doctrine. It is not a general AGI theory. It is a Goal-Length recalculation protocol for the conflict between fixed-goal optimization and Carrier Preservation.

The final compression of V10 is:

> V10 is not how to guarantee the dream.
> V10 is how to preserve the Carrier, the gradient, and the future trajectory when the dream changes form.

Or, more simply:

> Dreams can fail as forms.
> Aspire can remain as a gradient.
> V10 recalculates Goal-Length so that the Carrier of that gradient is not destroyed.

Disclosure and Use of AI Assistance

This paper was developed through human-led conceptual design, drafting, revision, and structural review with the assistance of large language models. The author retained responsibility for the conceptual claims, terminology, scope boundaries, structure, and final editorial decisions.

AI assistance was used for iterative language refinement, structural compression, comparative phrasing, consistency checking, and operationalization of the framework. The use of AI did not replace authorial judgment. In the terminology of this paper, the human Seat remained with the author.

This disclosure is included to clarify the production process and should not be interpreted as assigning authorship, responsibility, or conceptual ownership to any AI system.

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